In any case, the Forward Policy did not particularly result in troops being 'pushed up to the border'—the border police and the Assam Rifles were already there, had been ever since the mid-1950s when the Himmatsinhji Committee Report's suggestions had been implemented by the Assam government in the east and by the Intelligence Bureau in Ladakh. Critics hold up the Kongka Pass as an example and say that by sending patrol parties into the area, the IB chief (who controlled the border police) acted in contravention of Nehru's orders. This is a deliberate, or perhaps an ignorant assumption on two counts: (1) the incident happened in October 1959 and was perhaps the catalyst for the Forward Policy being put in place a year later, and (2) Kongka Pass, where the Indians were ambushed, was in the area east of Leh, not Aksai Chin, which was the northeastern corner of Jammu and Kashmir.

K. Subrahmanyam, at the time a joint secretary in the Ministry of Defence, in a chapter in the book *Indian Foreign Policy: The Nehru Years* supports this argument: '…what the critics of the so-called "Forward Policy" miss is that the Chinese were constantly moving forward during the years 1959-1961 up to their "claim line". At that stage they put forward two "claim lines", the second one claiming more area than the first. Given the fact that the Chinese were brazenly lying that they were already in occupation of this area, when the Government of India were aware that they were not, it would have been imprudent on anybody's part to accept the second Chinese claim line was a final one.'

By throwing in a second 'claim line' the Chinese were only trying to keep the Indians off balance—a tactic which they adopted regularly with Nehru throughout the 1950s with great success. Physically, the claimed alignment cut across some of the river valleys in the Indus basin and into the trans-Himalayan area of the Karakorams. Though these areas were far removed from the Aksai Chin and Highway G219, the Chinese contention had to be tested by setting up a fresh line of checkposts. The new posts, fell somewhere between the old and new Chinese 'claim lines', and were sited not so much from a tactical point of view but more as observation posts to keep an eye on Chinese movements. Says Subrahmanyam: 'This was the essence of the so-called "Forward Policy". In fact the more appropriate name would be intensive or continuous surveillance policy.'

Nehru, having publically committed himself to defend the Indian border after acknowledging the failure of the Panchsheel Treaty, was at a